

Wire — Unit Economics

The most expensive rail per transaction

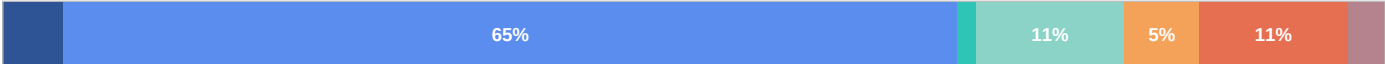
FULLY-LOADED COST PER TRANSACTION

\$18.570

Saves \$17.80 per txn if migrated to instant

Cost component	Detail	Amount	% of total
1. Network fee		\$0.820	4.4%
2. Processing / operations		\$12.000	64.6%
3. Failure & exception	1.0% return × \$25.00/item	\$0.250	1.3%
4. Fraud loss (expected)		\$2.000	10.8%
5. Fraud prevention / screening		\$1.000	5.4%
6. Compliance (AML / sanctions)		\$2.000	10.8%
7. Reconciliation		\$0.500	2.7%
8. Liquidity / prefunding		\$0.000	0.0%
TOTAL		\$18.570	100.0%

Cost composition (share of the fully-loaded cost)



What this means: The Fedwire fee is tiny (~\$0.82). What makes a wire cost **\$18.57** is **labor and risk**: manual initiation, callback verification, dual approval, mandatory OFAC screening, and high fraud exposure. Second-biggest migration target after checks.

Sources: Network fees — Fed / Nacha / The Clearing House pricing. Failure rates — Nacha return thresholds (~1.5% typical); failed-payment cost ~\$12.10 (LexisNexis). Fraud — AFP Payments Fraud Survey; 2024 losses check ~\$24B, ACH ~\$11B, APP ~\$12.5B. Compliance — FFIEC / BSA-AML. Liquidity — RTP prefunded joint account (frbservices.org). All figures are conservative public-benchmark midpoints, to be calibrated with Payfinia production data. See Deliverable 1.